

Unit: Language: Potato, Potato

詳細內容雙語對照 / Detailed Bilingual Content

Lead-in Dialogue / 導入對話

Are you assuming that this unit is about food like potato and vegetables? It is not. You will not believe me if I tell you my next sentence is 'tomato, tomato'. You definitely will say: We know these words already. Tell us something we don't know!! Of course I will, because this is exactly why this course is designed for.

你是否認為本單元是關於馬鈴薯和蔬菜等食物的？它不是。如果我告訴你我的下一句話是『tomato, tomato (番茄·番茄 / 一回事)』，你一定不會相信我。你肯定會說：我們已經知道這些字了。告訴我們一些我們不知道的事吧！我當然會，因為這正是本課程設計的目的。

Jane: Emma!!! I need some help!! Have you got a minute? Emma: I'm busy with my book report, but... ok, what's the matter? Jane: I'm going out with the guy Charles, you know from last week, tonight for dinner. I need your opinion on my top! Do you think I should wear this dark blue sweater which shows the color of my eyes more or this black one which makes me look thinner? Emma: What? That's your problem? Are you crazy? Who cares? Potayto, potahto, it's the same thing. Who cares? They look the same in the dark anyway. I can't believe you interrupted me for this (sigh....) Jane: Well, thank you very much for being so helpful. Your opinion really matters to me OK? Remember, we are BFF!! Emma: Ok, fine, the black one. It can never go wrong with the black.

簡：艾瑪！！我需要一些幫助！！你有空嗎？艾瑪：我正忙著寫讀書報告，不過.....好吧，什麼事？簡：我今晚要和上週那個叫查爾斯的傢伙出去吃晚飯。我需要你對我的上衣提點意見！你覺得我應該穿這件顯得我眼睛顏色的深藍色毛衣，還是穿這件顯得更瘦的黑色毛衣？艾瑪：什麼？那是你的問題？你瘋了嗎？誰在乎？Potayto, potahto (馬鈴薯·馬鈴薯 / 一回事)，都是一樣的。誰在乎？反正暗處看起來都一樣。我不敢相信你為這事打斷我 (嘆氣.....) 簡：好吧，非常感謝你這麼有幫助。你的意見對我很重要好嗎？記住，我們是死黨！！艾瑪：好吧，行了，黑色的那件。穿黑色永遠不會出錯。

Linguistics & Language Change / 語言學與語言演變

Many of us know that English, through history, has developed slightly in different parts of the world. In the study of Linguistics, we linguists study various languages, researching a language through phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics and applications. Phonology is the study of sounds, while morphology looks into the structure and root of a word. Syntax is the study of sentence pattern, i.e. grammar, whereas semantics is about the meaning of words in different levels, such as word, phrase and sentence, discourse analysis and pragmatics. Applied linguistics covers how a language is used from even wider perspectives, such as psycho-linguistics, socio-linguistics, language change, language acquisition, language learning and teaching etc. These proper terms seem difficult, but we do not need to learn everything now. We only need to learn what area they refer to for now.

我們中許多人都知道，在歷史上，英語在世界不同地區的發展略有不同。在語言學研究中，我們語言學家研究各種語言，通過語音學、形態學、句法學、語意學和應用來研究一門語言。語音學是研究聲音的學科，而形態學則研究單字的結構和字根

。句法學是研究句子模式的學科，即語法，而語意學是關於不同層次單字含義的學科，例如單字、片語和句子、語篇分析和語用學。應用語言學涵蓋了從更廣泛的角度如何使用語言，例如心理語言學、社會語言學、語言演變、語言習得、語言學習和教學等。這些專有名詞看起來很難，但我們現在不需要學習所有內容。我們現在只需要了解它們指的是什麼領域。

Do you think languages change fast? Some might say ‘yes’ because quite often we need to learn new words or phrases in order to keep up with the world, such as ‘IG’ for “Instagram” and ‘KOL’ for “Key Opinion Leader” in recent years since the social media become our new normal. Nevertheless, if we think about this more carefully, these are just phrases. So, words come and go, but one thing remains relatively stable, which is the grammar of a language. Take English as an example, even though the grammar of English has changed to a certain extent from Middle English, the core of the grammar did not change much. That is, the structure of the grammar remains the same, while the vocabulary could change more easily, generally speaking. Back in the mid 1990s, the Internet has just started to become popular, which increased the use of email for correspondence. Since then, words like ‘download’ , ‘broadband’ , and ‘online’ were invented with the advancement of technology. These were the evidence of how vocabulary and slangs could change over time more easily than grammar.

你認為語言變化快嗎？有些人可能會說『快』，因為我們經常需要學習新的單字或片語以跟上世界的腳步，例如近年來由於社群媒體成為我們的新常態，『IG』代表「Instagram」，『KOL』代表「關鍵意見領袖」。然而，如果我們更仔細地思考這一點，這些只是流行語。因此，單字來來去去，但有一件事保持相對穩定，那就是一門語言的語法。以英語為例，儘管英語語法從中古英語起發生了一定程度的變化，但語法的核心並沒有太大變化。也就是說，語法的結構保持不變，而一般來說，詞彙更容易發生變化。早在1990年代中期，網際網路剛剛開始流行，這增加了電子郵件用於通信的頻率。從那時起，隨著技術的進步，『下載 (download) 』、『寬頻 (broadband) 』和『線上 (online) 』等單字被發明出來。這些都是詞彙和俚語隨時間推移比語法更容易發生變化的證據。

Sounds of Language: US vs. UK Pronunciation / 語言的聲音：美式與英式發音

Now, let's get into the main topic of this unit, the sounds of language. We know that American English and British English sound different. (If you have not had any contact with British English, you could watch a movie of Harry Potter and listen to them carefully.) In fancier words, we can say the 'pronunciations' of them are different. Based on my English learning and teaching experience and to put things more simply, the main differences are the vowels and the curling tongue. In Taiwan, English learners often learn through KK phonetic symbols, which is an effective way to learn pronunciation. Once you master the symbols, you can pronounce the word rather correctly. KK phonetic symbols are adopted in American English and internationally. British English (or English English) usually takes the DJ phonetic symbols and includes some vowels that either do not exist or are pronounced differently, which leads to the different pronunciation of a word. For instance, the ~er sound /ɜ/ in KK phonetic symbol requires the curl up of the tongue, whereas in British English, the tongue is comparatively flat. In addition, the /r/ in the word 'farm' is less obvious than that in American English. Other differences regarding vowels or even diphthongs exist, such as the vowel in 'hot' and 'water' /ɒ/ and the diphthong /ɔɪ/. Due to the different phonetic systems, we have different pronunciations of the same words. In the end, the word 'potato' has two pronunciations in the English language, potayto and potahto, referring to the same word. So, in English, when we say 'potayto, potahto', we mean the two things under discussion are the same thing, with minor tiny unimportant differences between them.

現在，讓我們進入本單元的主題，語言的聲音。我們知道美式英語和英式英語聽起來不同。(如果您還沒有接觸過英式英語，您可以觀看一部《哈利波特》的電影並仔細聆聽。)用更精緻的話來說，我們可以說它們的『發音』不同。根據我的英語學習和教學經驗，更簡單地說，主要的區別在於母音和捲舌音。在台灣，英語學習者經常通過 KK 音標進行學習，這是學習發音的有效方法。一旦您掌握了音標，您就可以相當正確地讀出單字。KK 音標在美式英語和國際上被採用。英式英語（或英國英語）通常採用 DJ 音標，並包括一些要麼不存在要麼發音不同的母音，這導致了單字的不同發音。例如，KK 音標中的 ~er 音 /ɜ/ 需要舌頭捲起，而在英式英語中，舌頭相對較平。此外，單字『farm』中的 /r/ 在美式英語中比在英式英語中更不明顯。還存在關於母音甚至雙母音的其他差異，例如『hot』和『water』中的母音 /ɒ/ 以及雙母音 /ɔɪ/。由於不同的語音系統，我們對相同的單字有不同的發音。最後，『potato』這個字在英語中有兩種發音，potayto 和 potahto，指的是同一個字。所以，在英語中，當我們說『potayto, potahto』時，我們是指所討論的兩件事是一回事，它們之間只有微不足道的不重要差異。

Song: Let's Call the Whole Thing Off / 經典歌曲：讓我們取消這一切（不分手了）

This English idiom or we can say expression came from a song "Let's call it off" (officially "Let's Call the Whole Thing Off") in the movie "Shall We Dance" long time ago in 1937. The song was sung by Ella Fitzgerald and Louis Armstrong. It was set in a duet style and the main characters of the song, a couple (yet-to-be couple) were arguing whether the relationship should go on over their different pronunciations of 'words', which for sure was not an appropriate reason to stop a relationship. However, the song pointed out if the two could not agree with each other on something this subtle, how they should continue the relationship in the future. Fortunately, we see in the end of the song, they decided to 'call the whole thing off', which meant that they decided to stay together! Hooray! What a relief! It's a happy ending for everyone. You can find many different examples like the 'potayto, potahto', 'tomayto, tomahto', 'either', 'neither', 'pajama', 'oyster'.

這個英語成語或者我們可以說表達方式來自很久以前1937年電影《隨我起舞》(Shall We Dance) 中的一首歌《Let' s Call the Whole Thing Off》。這首歌由艾拉·費茲潔拉 (Ella Fitzgerald) 和路易斯·阿姆斯壯 (Louis Armstrong) 以二重唱的形式演唱。歌曲的男女主角，一對即將成為戀人的情侶，正在為他們不同的單字『發音』爭論這段關係是否應該繼續下去，這無疑不是停止一段關係的合適理由。然而，這首歌指出，如果兩個人在如此微妙的事情上都無法達成一致，那麼他們未來應該如何繼續這段關係。幸運的是，我們在歌曲的結尾看到，他們決定『call the whole thing off (取消取消 / 不分手了) 』，這意味著他們決定待在一起！萬歲！真令人鬆了一口氣！這對每個人來說都是一個快樂的結局。您可以找到許多不同的例子，如『potayto, potahto』、『tomayto, tomahto』、『either』、『neither』、『pajama』、『oyster』。

Song Lyrics / 歌詞對照

You say either and I say eye-ther You say neither and I say n-eye-ther Either, eye-ther, neither, n-eye-ther Let' s call the whole thing off.

你說 either · 我說 eye-ther 你說 neither · 我說 n-eye-ther Either, eye-ther, neither, n-eye-ther 讓我們把整件事取消吧。

You like potato and I like pot-ah-to You like tomato and I like tom-ah-to Potato, pot-ah-to, tomato, to-mah-to, Let' s call the whole thing off

你喜歡 potato · 我喜歡 pot-ah-to 你喜歡 tomato · 我喜歡 tom-ah-to Potato, pot-ah-to, tomato, to-mah-to, 讓我們把整件事取消吧

So if you like pyjamas and I like pyj-ah-mas I' ll wear pyjamas and give up py-jah-mas For we know we need each other so we Better call the calling off off Let' s call the whole thing off.

如果你喜歡 pyjamas · 而我喜歡 pyj-ah-mas 我會穿 pyjamas · 放棄 py-jah-mas 因為我們知道彼此需要，所以我們最好不要取消這段感情 讓我們把取消的事情取消吧 (別分手了) 。

American vs. British English Vocabulary / 美式與英式字彙對照

French fries (American) -> chips (British) | 炸薯條

French fries (美式) -> chips (英式) | 炸薯條

fall (American) -> autumn (British) | 秋天

fall (美式) -> autumn (英式) | 秋天

attorney (American) -> solicitor (British) | 律師

attorney (美式) -> solicitor (英式) | 律師

cookie (American) -> biscuit (British) | 餅乾

cookie (美式) -> biscuit (英式) | 餅乾

janitor (American) -> caretaker (British) | 管理員/工友

janitor (美式) -> caretaker (英式) | 管理員/工友

drugstore (American) -> chemist' s, pharmacist' s (British) | 藥局/藥妝店

drugstore (美式) -> chemist' s, pharmacist' s (英式) | 藥局/藥妝店

apartment (American) -> flat (British) | 公寓

apartment (美式) -> flat (英式) | 公寓

yard (American) -> garden (British) | 庭院/花園

yard (美式) -> garden (英式) | 庭院/花園

vacation (American) -> holiday (British) | 假期

vacation (美式) -> holiday (英式) | 假期

elevator (American) -> lift (British) | 電梯

elevator (美式) -> lift (英式) | 電梯

truck (American) -> lorry (British) | 卡車

truck (美式) -> lorry (英式) | 卡車

sidewalk (American) -> pavement (British) | 人行道

sidewalk (美式) -> pavement (英式) | 人行道

mail (American) -> post (British) | 郵件

mail (美式) -> post (英式) | 郵件

line (American) -> queue (British) | 排隊

line (美式) -> queue (英式) | 排隊

subway (American) -> underground railway/tube (British) | 地鐵

subway (美式) -> underground railway/tube (英式) | 地鐵